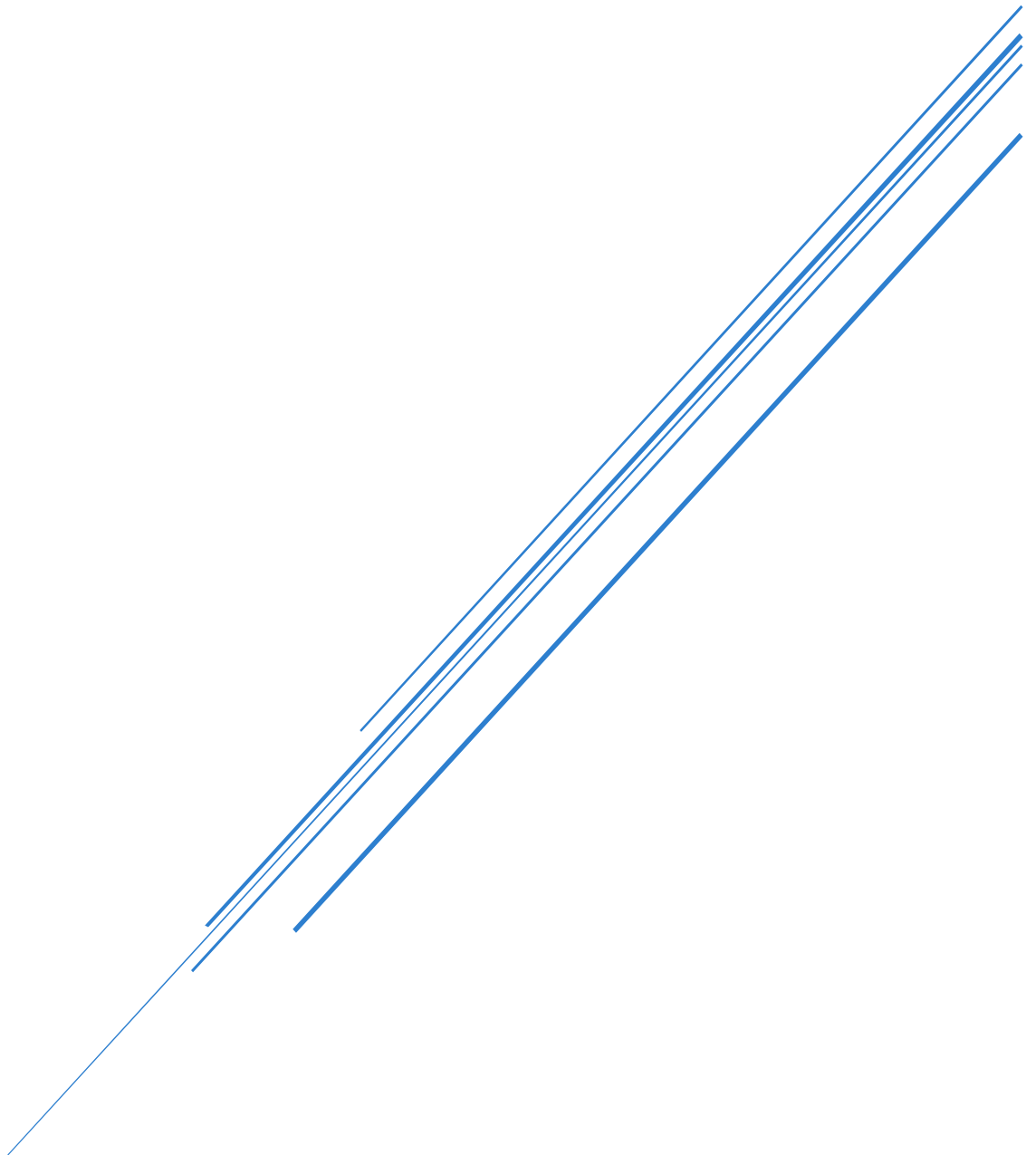


PROG7313 FORMATIVE PART 1

IIE EMERIS PIETERMARITZBURG



17/03/2026

Group Members

Prashik Gangaparsad - ST10401917

Kelleesha Naidoo - ST10451846

Thandokuhle Lungani Junior Dlamini - ST10447313

Table of Contents

Introduction	3
APP 1: Cashew	3
Overview	3
Home page	3
Transaction page	4
Budgets App	4
Strengths and weaknesses of the app	5
APP 2: Daily Budget Planner: Spendee	6
Overview	6
Budget Managing	8
Monitoring Wallets	9
Activity Management	10
APP 3:	12
Home page	12
Accounts Page	13
Budget & Goals	16
Conclusion	20
References:	21

Research and Design - Introduction

In this modern era, if financial responsibility and widespread adoption of smartphones, having a personal budgeting application can be the determining factor. These apps can monitor user's income, expenditure, and their spending habits and goals.

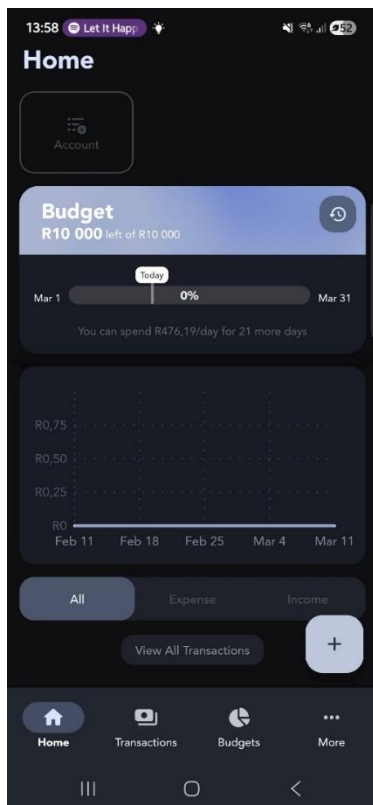
The purpose of this report is to review three budgeting applications: Wallet: Budget & Money Manager, Cashew, and Spendee. The report looks at the features, design, strengths, and weaknesses of each app. By analysing these apps, we can understand what works well and what could be improved. This will help us choose the best features to include in our own proposed budgeting application.

APP 1: Cashew

Cashew : Expense Budget Tracker is a personal finance app which is designed to helps users manage their personal finances efficiently and simplifying the way people track their spending, set budgets, and understand their financial habits

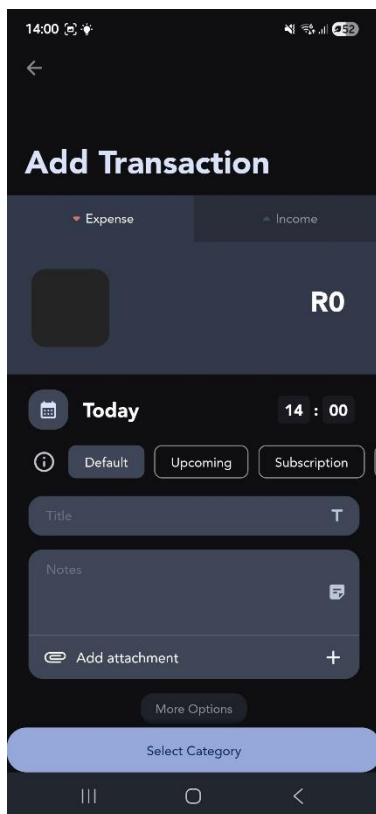
Overview

Home page



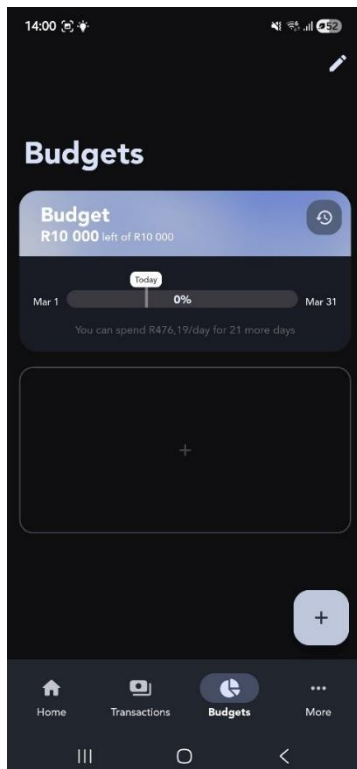
Dapper App Developer (2024) explains that the home page shows the main information about the user's money. At the top of the screen, the app will display the current budget amount. The home page will also display a graph that shows how much money is being spent from that current budget amount. Users can also see a list of recent transactions, including different categories such as food or transportation, the amount of money spent, or the date of the transaction. Dapper App Developer (2024) also shows that the quick add button allows users to quickly and manually add a new expense or income into the wallet.

Transaction page



Dapper App Developer (2024) explains that the transaction page shows a list of all transactions made over weeks and months. Each transaction can be displayed by category, such as food, transport, or entertainment, along with the amount spent or received and the date and time. Users can even filter and sort transactions by category such as food, bills, shopping or by any time period. Users also allowed to edit or delete transactions (Cashew, 2026).

Budgets App



Dapper App Developer (2024) explains that users can create budgets for different categories, such as groceries, transport, entertainment, or bills, and set a specific spending limit for each category. The budget page also displays progress bars which shows how much of the budget has already been spent. Budgets can be set for different time periods, including weekly, monthly, or custom time frames, helping users manage their finances more effectively (Cashew, 2026).

Strengths and weaknesses of the app

Strengths

The app has a clean and simple user interface which makes it easy for users to navigate and track their expenses without confusion. The app also provides charts and graphs that help users clearly see their spending patterns and understand where their money goes. Users can customise their accounts, and themes which makes the app more personal and organised.

Weaknesses

The app focuses mainly on expense tracking and budgeting, so it does not include any more advanced financial planning tools like crypto. Users must enter most transactions manually, which can take a lot of time and can be annoying. Unlike other budgeting apps, Cashew app does not automatically connect to bank accounts, so it cannot automatically track spending.

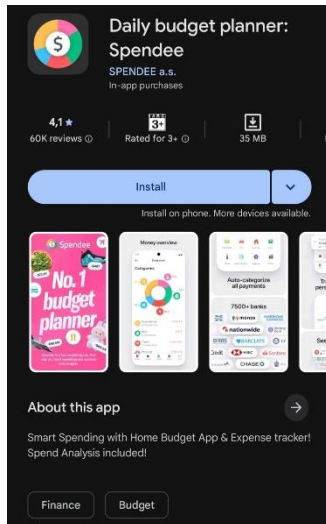
The innovations

The app does supports multiple currencies with different conversion rates, which is useful for users who travel or manage money in different currencies. The app even allows for Google Drive backups and allows for data to be exported, which allows for users to safely store and restore their financial information if they change devices or accounts.

APP 2: Daily Budget Planner: Spendee

Daily budget planner: Spendee. It is known to be a popular budget app because it's helpful to users when it comes to both monitoring and tracking their financial activities through the usage of tools and visual aids.

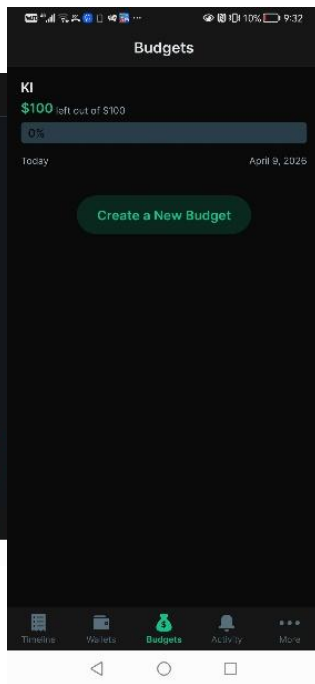
Overview



Spendee a.s (2026) explains that this app is identified to be a personal financial app. It is developed in such a way that it's both easy and simple for users to be able to keep track of their income, expenses, and monitoring budgets.

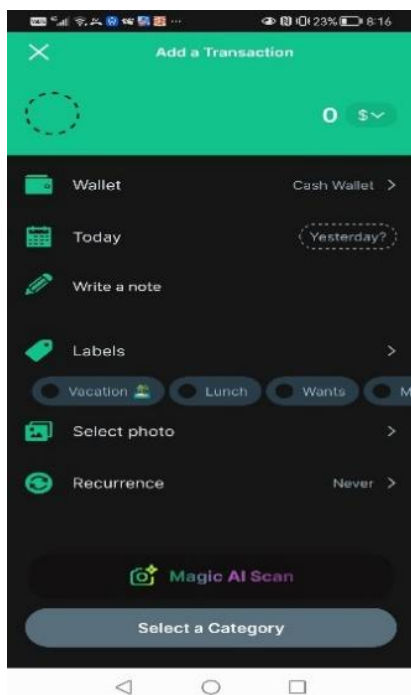
The reason why it's widely used is because it's less complicated when it comes to monitoring daily spending. It ensures that the users can clearly identify what is happening to their money and what habits they can change when it comes to saving (Spendee. 2018).





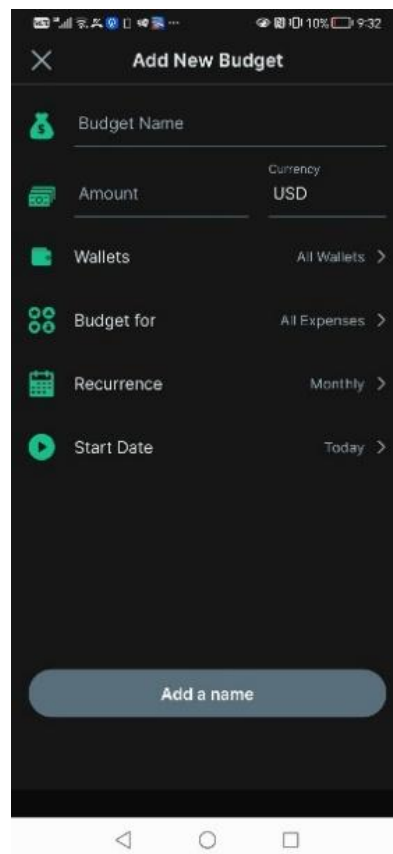
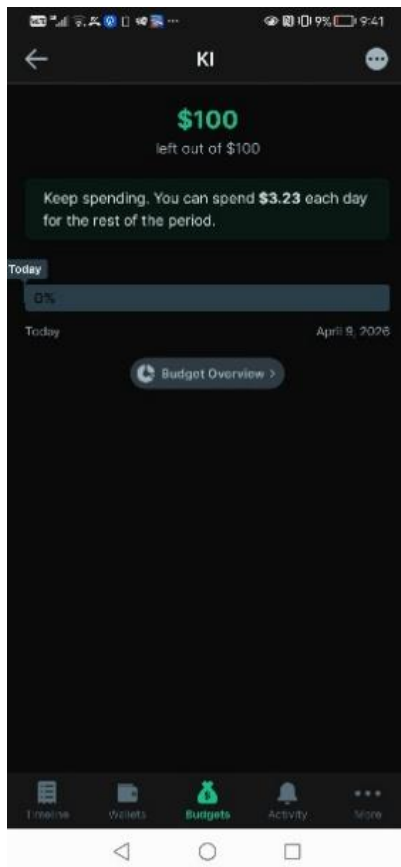
Income and Expenditure tracking

Spendee (2026) explains that the most crucial feature of this app is that it allows the user to monitor their income and expenses. A user can simply enter a transaction by inserting information like the date, labels, recurrence and what category it falls under e.g. transportation and could add notes about the transaction as well. They will also be able to add extra information about the transactions like images of the receipts of purchases (Spendee. 2018).

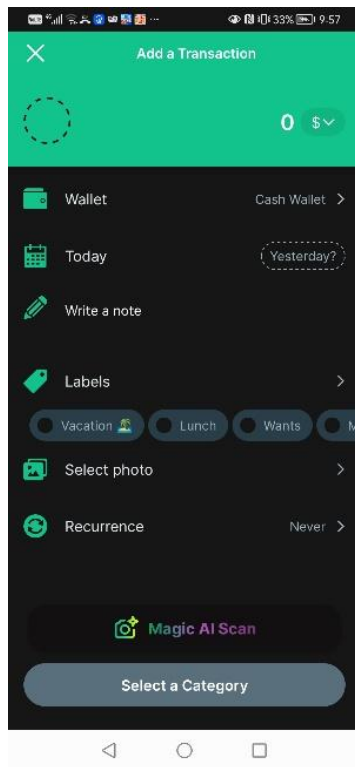


Budget Managing

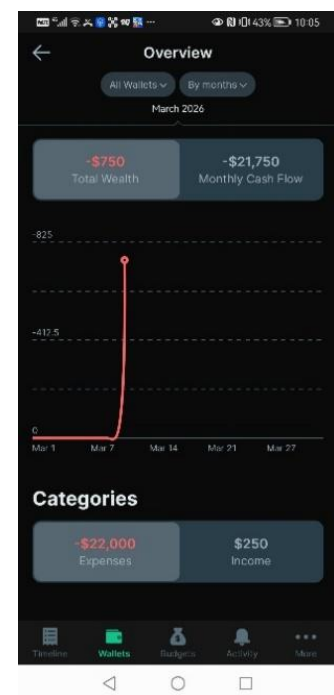
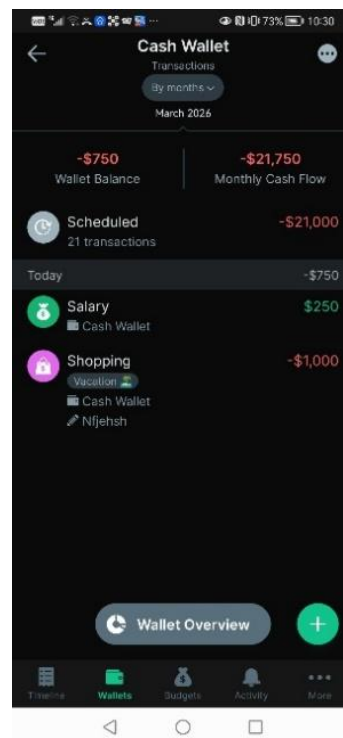
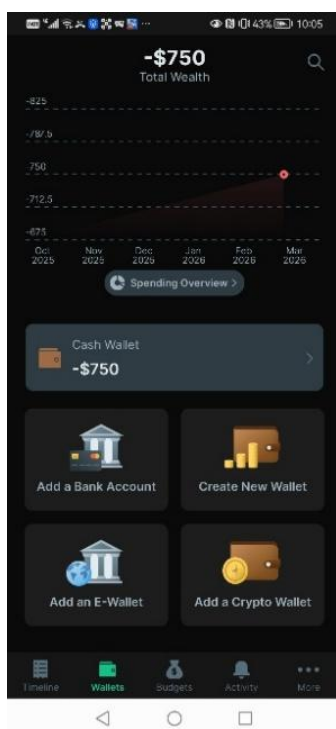
Spendee (2026) explains that when users click on the budget icon, they can develop budgets with the necessary information such as what currency is being used. After the budget is created, the app will display it and will show how much money can be used and when you click on budget overview, it will show how much can be spent from it.



Monitoring Wallets



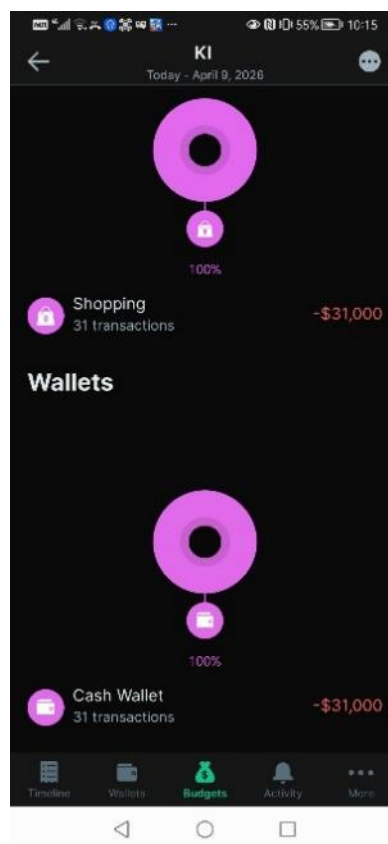
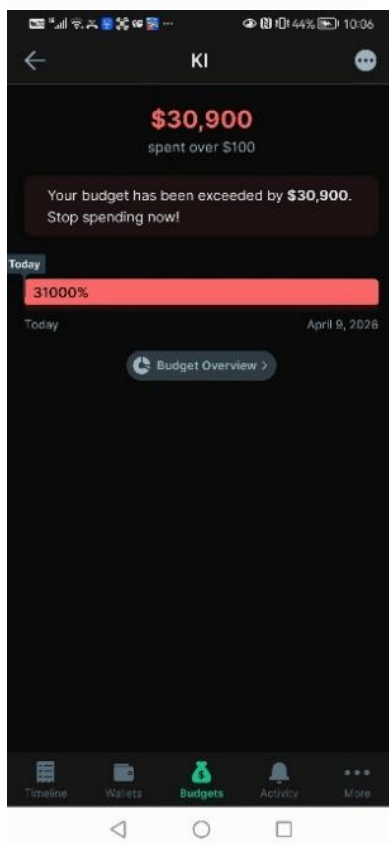
Spendee (2026) explains that users can create wallets by adding transactions with its required information. Once its created, it will display how much money is in. When the wallet is clicked on it will show the scheduled transactions and the different wallets that was used like cash wallet. It also displays other options to the user like adding a crypto wallet. When the spend-overview is clicked on it will show a more detailed graph so that user is able to see their expenses, income, total wealth and their monthly cash flow (Spendee. 2018).



Activity Management



Spendee (2026) explains that the activity feature allows the users to see their budgets and whether they kept to the budgeted amount or not. When the budget is clicked on, it displays how much of the budget was used. When the user goes into the budget overview it will display the different categories used in the budget as well as its number of transactions done for each one and what type of wallet was used e.g. cash wallet.



Strengths

The app has a simple user interface which makes it easy to navigate through without any issues especially for the new users. Also, by using visual aids like graphs to show the expenses and income helps the user to somewhat have an understanding about their spending habits and how they can change it to save money. It allows users to develop budgets for each category e.g. food as well as notifying them when the limit of the budget is reached.

Weaknesses

The only way for the user to get more functionality e.g. synchronising their bank account in their app is by getting the premium version of it which means users with the free version is limited to the basic functionality. It also doesn't provide tracking or management of investments so users may need to get other apps for that. Also, if a transaction was done by cash the user will have to manually insert it which becomes time-consuming.

Innovative Features

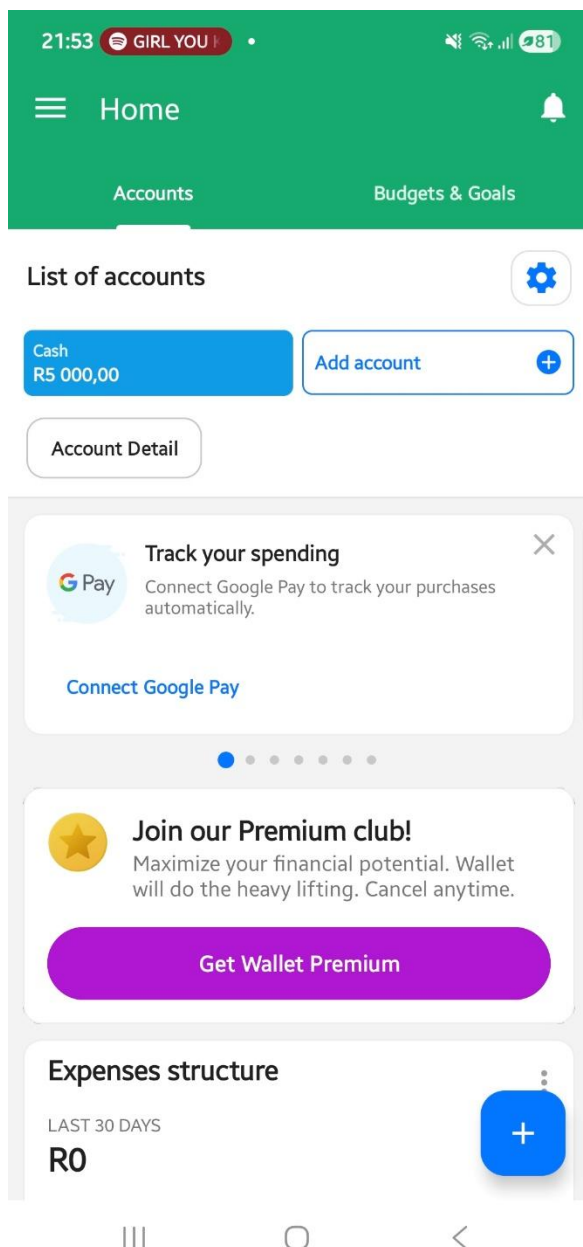
It has an AI receipt scanner implemented in it which means that users can just upload pictures of their receipts by scanning it and the app will extract the important information from it e.g. transaction date. The app can handle a variety of currencies and wallets which means that the user can create many wallets as they want while also tracking their expenditure in different currencies.

APP 3: Wallet: Budget & Money Manager App

Welcome to the Wallet: Budget & Money Manager App. The main purpose of the app is to help users plan budgets, monitor spending, and achieve financial goals. By recording daily expenses and organising them into categories, the app gives users a clear overview of where their money is going

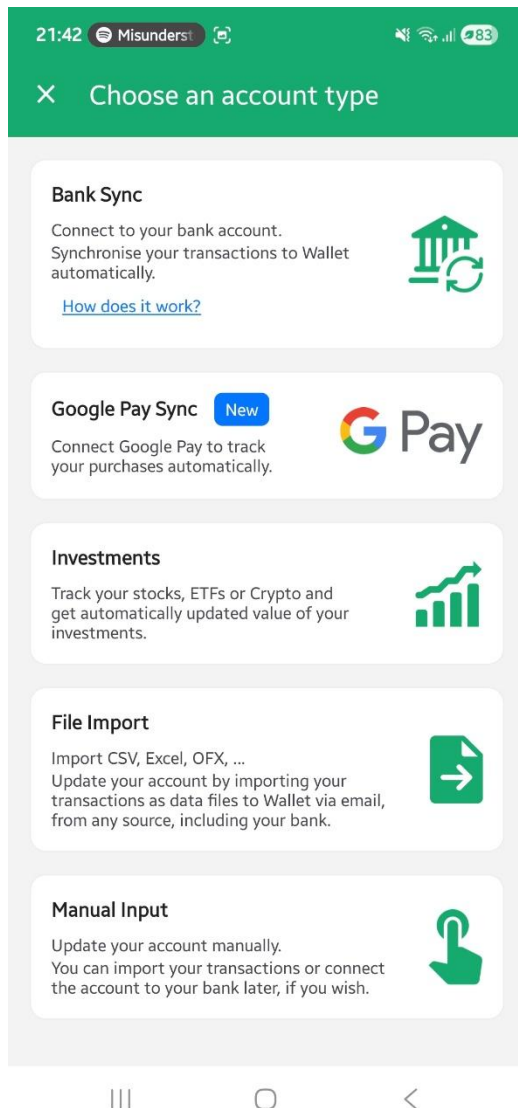
A. Overview

Home page



Budgetbakers (2026) explains that on the home screen of the app, two main tabs are displayed at the top of the screen. These tabs are labelled Accounts and Budgeting & Goals. The Accounts tab allows users to view and manage their financial accounts, while the Budgeting & Goals tab helps users track their budgets and monitor their financial goals (Budgetbakers, 2025).

Accounts Page

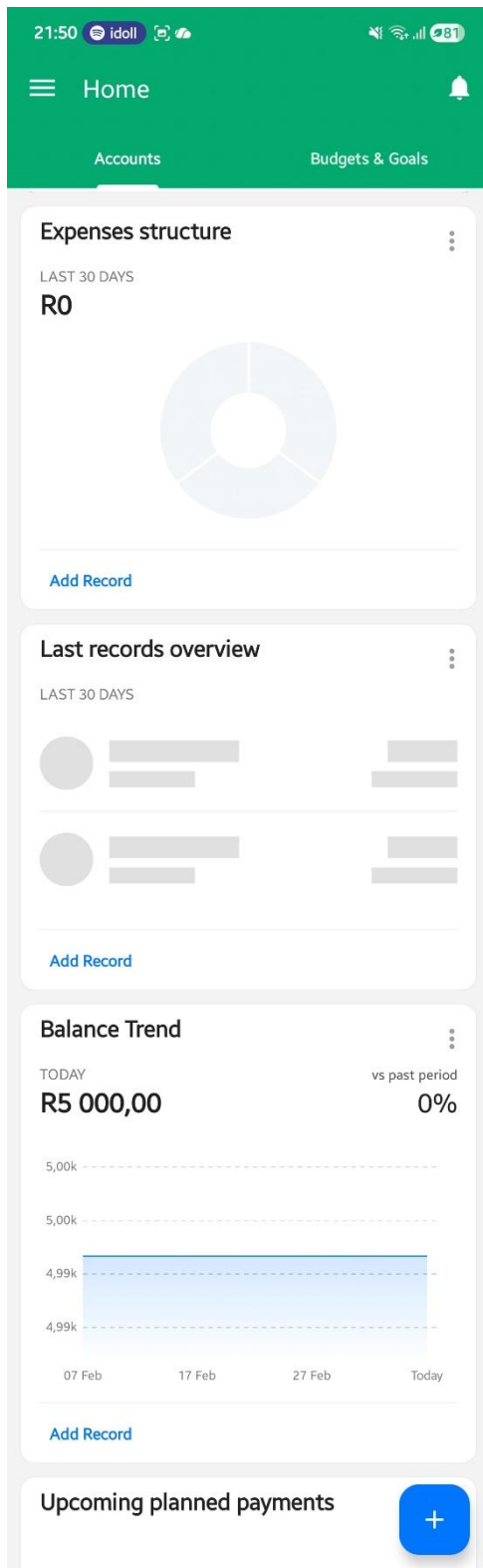


List of Accounts

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that this page displays the current amount of money available in the user's physical wallet. From this screen, users also have the option to add a new account to the application. Budgetbakers (2025) explains that the app provides several different account types that users can choose from depending on how they want to track their finances (Budgetbakers, 2025).

Users can:

- Add and sync their bank account to automatically track transactions.
- Connect Google Pay to monitor expenses made through the digital wallet.
- Add an investment account to keep track of stocks, ETFs, or cryptocurrency.



Expenses Structure

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that this feature provides a visual breakdown of your expenses using a pie chart, allowing you to see how your spending is distributed across different categories

Last Records Overview

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that displays all your transactions from the past 30 days, giving a quick summary of recent spending and income.

Balance Trend

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that shows the current balance over time in the form of a bar graph, helping users track how their finances change day by day or month by month.

21:43 JUDAS 83

✕ Add Planned payment ✓

Income Expense

Name

Category

Select category

Account

Cash

Amount

0

Currency

ZAR

Payment Type

Cash

Payee

Frequency

One time

Date

Select date

Notifications

None

Note

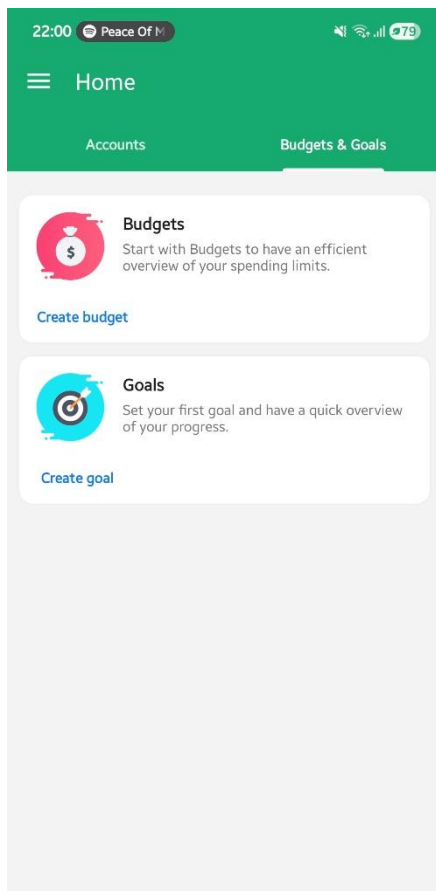
Labels

+ Add label

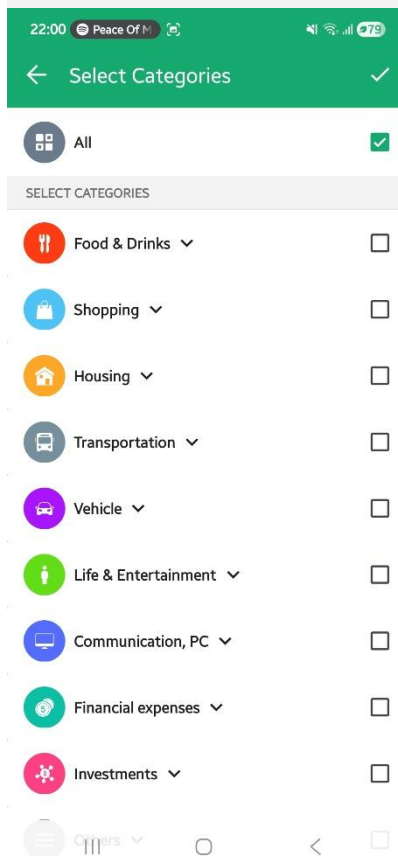
Upcoming planned payments

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that shows your upcoming payments that are added such as Spotify and/or gym membership.

Budget & Goals

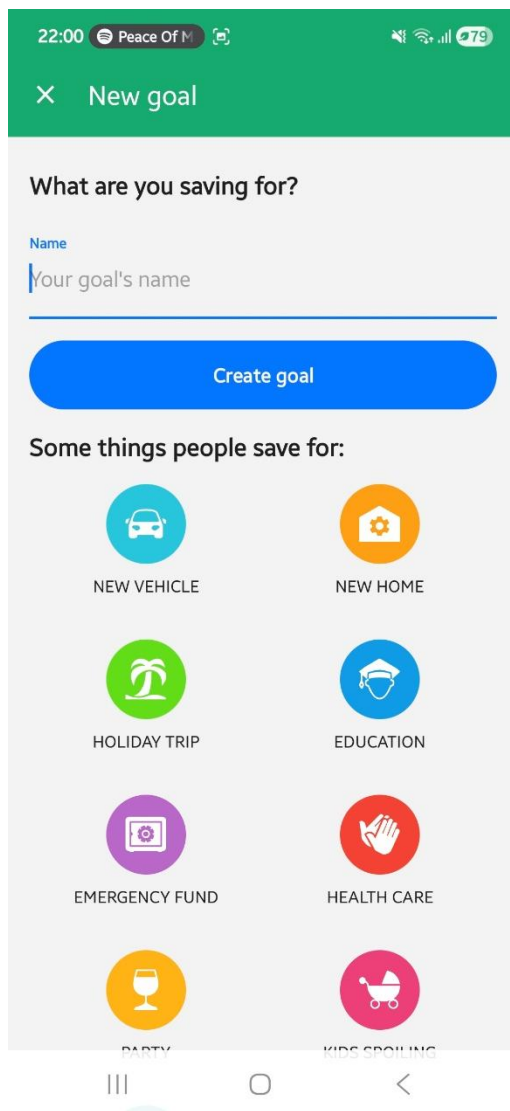


Budgetbakers (2026) explains that on this page, allows you to create Budgets and Goals for yourself



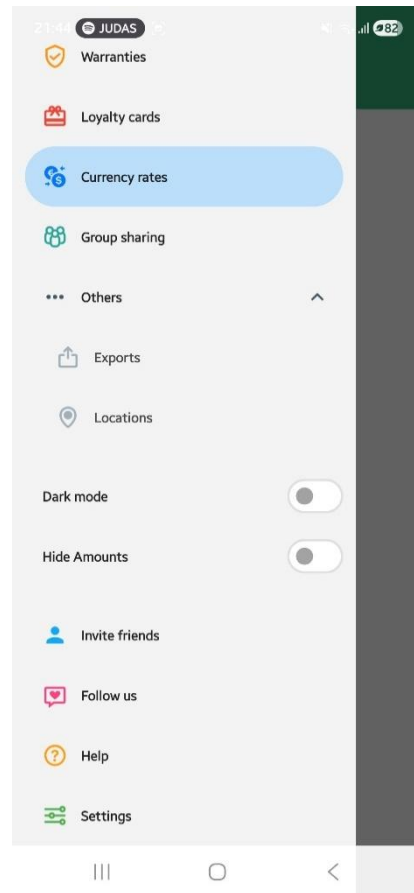
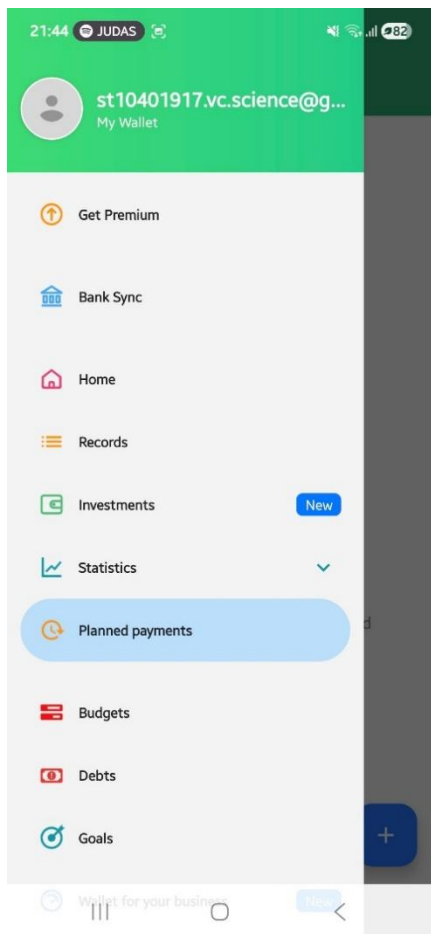
Budgets

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that when creating a budget, you can choose from a wide variety of categories and set an amount



Goals

Budgetbakers (2026) explains that when you open the goals tab, the app will you to enter a goals name for what you are trying to save up for. The app will also give a couple of preset options to choose from such as saving for a vehicle or a new home (Budgetbakers, 2025).



Strengths

The app has a user-friendly layout, which makes it easy to navigate and use. It also offers many features and customisation options that help users manage different types of budgets. Users are allowed to add loyalty cards, keeping all financial tools in one place. The app also provides extra security by requiring a fingerprint scan to unlock it. In addition, it includes detailed statistics and infographics that help users visualise their expenses, budgets, and investments more clearly.

Weaknesses

Some features are restricted behind a paywall, which can be unlocked through monthly, yearly, or one-time payments.

Innovation

Users can connect their bank accounts directly, allowing automatic tracking of transactions and the app supports Google Pay integration, enabling the app to monitor the digital wallet expenses.

A list of the best features from all the apps

- Easy user interface, friendly layouts, easy to navigate and use
- The app does support multiple currencies with different conversion rates, which is useful for users who travel or manage money in different currencies.
- The app supports Google Pay integration, enabling the app to monitor digital wallet expenses.
- Provides extra security by requiring a fingerprint scan to unlock the app.
- Visual aids e.g charts show the expenses and income helps the user to somewhat have an understanding about their spending habits and how they can change it to save money
- Offers a lot of features and customization options for managing different types of budgets.

Conclusion

After all analysis of all three applications, each brings its own strengths and weaknesses. The best features we identified to include in our proposed application will be rewards and badges, voice controls, finger and face recognition login. These features and the strength of all three applications will allow us to create our application to be a user-friendly, innovative, comprehensive budgeting solution currently.

References:

- BudgetBakers, 2025. *Your Finances in One Place*. [online] Available at: <<https://budgetbakers.com/en/>> [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- BudgetBakers, 2026. *Wallet: Budget & Money Manager*. Version 9.2.12. [app] Available at: < <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.droid4you.application.wallet> > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Cashew, 2026. Finally, budget like a boss. [online]. Available at: < <https://cashewapp.web.app/index.html> > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Dapper App Developer, 2025. *Cashew—Expense Budget Tracker*. Version 5.4.4. [app]. Available at: < https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.budget.tracker_app > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Spendee a.s., 2026. *Budget App & Tracker: Spendee*. Version 5.5.50. [app]. Available at: < <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.cleevio.spendee> > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Spendee, 2018. *The only app that gets your money into shape*. [online] Available at: < <https://www.spendee.com/> > [Accessed 12 March 2026].

Table of Contents

<u>Introduction</u>	23
<u>Brief overview:</u>	23
<u>Requirements of the app:</u>	24
<u>USER INTERFACE DESIGN</u>	26
<u>PROJECT PLAN</u>	32
<u>Conclusion</u>	34
<u>References</u>	34

Introduction

When it comes to designing a budgeting app, the app needs to be functional, interactive, and consumer friendly. Also, developing a financial application can be a challenging process. It needs to be easy to use while at the same time it needs to provide users with an efficient way when it comes to saving money and enhancing their spending habits. Taking the best features from previous applications and implementing those that are suitable, the proposed app can be designed to meet the user's basic needs and gives them more ability to save and manage their money effectively.

Brief overview:



Welcome to the BudgetHero! Save like a Hero

Description of innovative features:

BudgetHero will be a personal budgeting app which will be designed to help users track their expenses, monitor spending habits, and achieve their financial goals. The app provides a simple interface where users can record transactions, categorise expenses, and set monthly budgets. BudgetHero will have a super easy to use interface which will allow any type of user to operate the app. BudgetHero will support multiple currencies and will have up to date conversion rates which will allow for users who travel or manage money in different currencies.

BudgetHero will integrate with Google Pay, Samsung Pay, and Apple Pay allowing for users to track their digital wallet expenses inside the BudgetHero App. For extra security, BudgetHero will require a fingerprint scan to enter the app. BudgetHero will be filled with visual aids which will help users understand their income and spending habits, allowing users to see where they can save money more. BudgetHero will also offer a variety of features and different customization options for managing different types of budgets. One of the coolest features of the app is that it will have an AI receipt scanner that will be included implemented, which means that users can just upload pictures of their receipts by scanning it and the app will extract the important information and interpret it.

Requirements of the app:

Income and Expense Tracking:

Lets users keep track of all the money you get and spend. You can type in transactions yourself or link the app to your bank, so it updates automatically (Nectar Money, 2026).

Expense Categorization:

Organizes your spending into categories like groceries, rent, entertainment, or transport. This makes it easier to see where your money is going (Nectar Money, 2026).

Digital Wallet integration:

Allows users to add a Google Pay, Samsung Pay, and Apple Pay allowing for users to track digital wallet expenses inside the App (Budgetbakers, 2025).

Notifications and Alerts:

Sends reminders when you are close to reaching your budget limit or when a bill is coming up (Digital Humanity, 2026).

Visual Reports and Dashboards:

Shows simple charts and graphs so you can easily see your money situation, like how much you've spent versus how much you have left (BudgetBakers, 2025)

Security Features:

Keeps your financial information safe with things like secure logins, two-step verification, and encryption (Digital Humanity, 2026).

AI Scanner:

An AI-powered receipt scanner will be implemented in the app which will allows users to upload or scan pictures of their receipts. The system will automatically extract and interpret important information from the receipt (Spendee, 2018).

App Customization:

Users can change the theme or appearance of the app, such as switching between different colours or dark and light modes and as well the changing the font text and size.

Own features:

Rewards and Badges

The app will have a reward system where users can earn badges for completing money challenges, such as staying within their budget or reaching a savings goal. This makes budgeting more fun and motivates users to manage their money better.

Shared Budgets

According to Grantham (2025), users will be able to create shared budgets with friends, family, or partners. Everyone can add expenses and see how much money is left in the shared budget, which makes it easier to manage group spending.

Voice Controls

Sgwebapp (2025) explains that voice controls will allow users to add expenses, check their balance, or view their budgets by using voice commands. This makes the app faster and easier to use.

AI Chatbot

Eleken (2020) suggests that using an AI chatbot can help users with their finances. Users can ask questions about their spending and get simple advice on how to save money or manage their budget.

Fingerprint or Face ID Login

The app will allow users to log in using a fingerprint or Face ID. This helps keep the user's financial information safe and secure (Digital Humanity, 2026).

User interface design (NEXT PAGE)

USER INTERFACE DESIGN



This is the first the page the user will when they open the app for the time, the user will prompt to login withing their email or using their google account



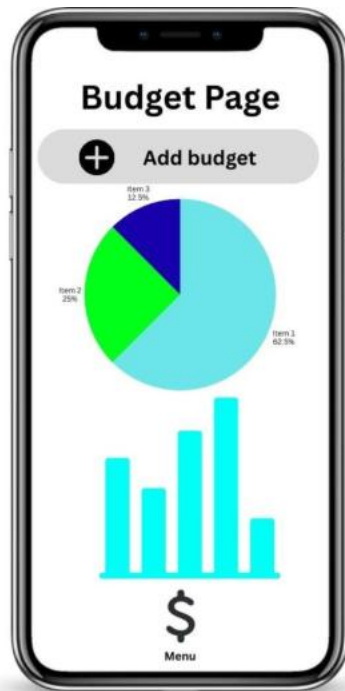
This is the main menu page. This page allows the user to navigate between the different pages on the app



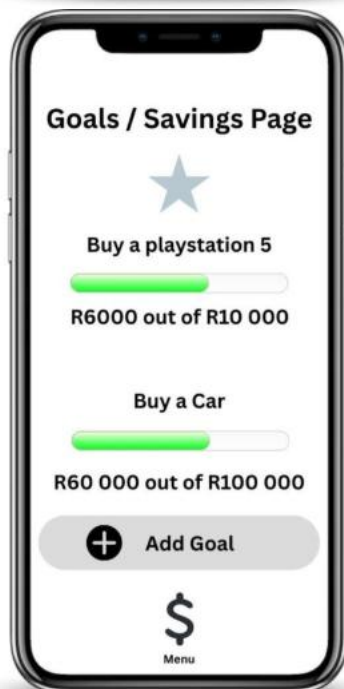
This is the home page. This page will show display much money is available in that certain wallet. Below that, is the expenditure graph will the flow of income and expenses in the account.



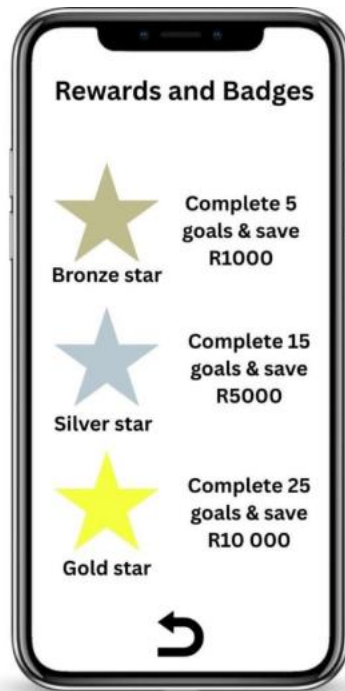
This is the transaction page. This page will the user the current and upcoming expenses that will be charged to the account. They also add any transaction manually using the add transaction button.



This is the budget page. This shows how much money is being spent in different categories. Users can also add their own budget using the add budget button.



This is the Goals / savings page. This page will display to the user their current goals they want to reach. Users can add more goals using the add goal button. The star on the top of the screen represents their reward badge



This is the rewards and badges page. This will display to the user the types of badges they once they achieve a certain goal



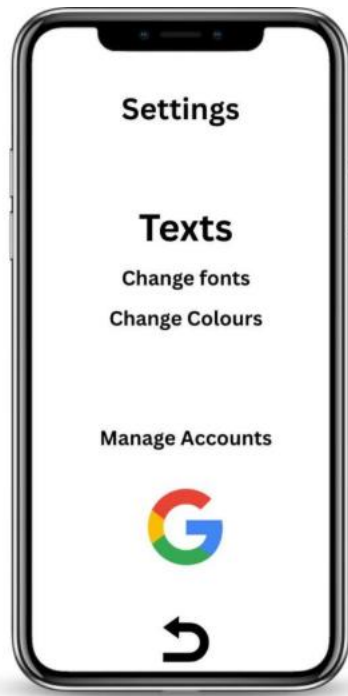
This is the report / analytic page. This page will display every single bit of information about the user's budget.



This is the AI chatbot. Users ask the AI a wide range of questions. Such as “how much money did I spend and save today”



This is the AI Scanner page. This allows for the user to automatically scan receipts for expenses and the AI will record the transaction in the app



This is the settings page. This page allows for the users to customize the app and manage their accounts.

PROJECT PLAN

	ID	Task Name	Start	End	Duration
1	▼ Research Phase		2026-03-09	2026-03-27	15 days
2	Examine existing budget apps		2026-03-09	2026-03-13	5 days
3	Identify innovative features of the apps		2026-03-16	2026-03-20	5 days
4	Evaluate strength and weaknesses of the apps		2026-03-23	2026-03-27	5 days
5	Research completed		2026-03-27	2026-03-27	0 days
6	▼ Planning Phase		2026-03-30	2026-04-17	15 days
7	Determine project goals and scope		2026-03-30	2026-04-03	5 days
8	Specify app requirements		2026-04-06	2026-04-10	5 days
9	Develop a timeline for the project		2026-04-13	2026-04-17	5 days
10	Project plan finalized		2026-04-17	2026-04-17	0 days
11	▼ Design Phase		2026-04-20	2026-05-15	20 days
12	Decide on the main features of the app		2026-04-20	2026-04-24	5 days
13	Design the UI/UX layout for the screens		2026-04-27	2026-05-01	5 days
14	Strategize navigation between the screens		2026-05-04	2026-05-08	5 days
15	Devlop mock up screens of the app		2026-05-11	2026-05-15	5 days
16	Designing of app is completed		2026-05-15	2026-05-15	0 days
17	▼ Development Phase		2026-05-18	2026-06-26	30 days
18	Setup Android studio		2026-05-18	2026-05-22	5 days
19	Develop main layouts and functions		2026-05-25	2026-05-29	5 days
20	Implement core features of the app		2026-06-01	2026-06-12	10 days
21	Implement additional features of the app		2026-06-15	2026-06-26	10 days
22	Features for the app is completed		2026-06-26	2026-06-26	0 days
23	▼ Testing Phase		2026-06-29	2026-07-31	25 days
24	Test app features		2026-06-29	2026-07-10	10 days
25	Test data capturing		2026-07-13	2026-07-17	5 days
26	Test navigation through screens		2026-07-20	2026-07-24	5 days
27	Check for any bugs		2026-07-27	2026-07-31	5 days

28	Testing of app is completed	2026-07-31	2026-07-31	0 days
29	▼ Bug Phase	2026-08-03	2026-08-28	20 days
30	Fix bugs and issues in the app	2026-08-03	2026-08-14	10 days
31	Test data capturing	2026-08-17	2026-08-21	5 days
32	Enhance app performance and UI	2026-08-24	2026-08-28	5 days
33	Reliable prototype ready	2026-08-28	2026-08-28	0 days
34	▼ Documentation Phase	2026-08-31	2026-09-04	5 days
35	Develop project report	2026-08-31	2026-09-04	5 days
37	Project completed	2026-09-04	2026-09-04	0 days

Conclusion

Thus, designing a financial application to be functional, interactive, and consumer-friendly can be a challenging process. By reviewing features from different budget apps and taking the best ones and implementing them, the proposed app is functioned to provide help to users when it comes to tracking their income, managing their expenses as well as understanding their spending habits. Therefore, the app will be able to meet the basic needs of the users while at the same time enabling them to save money and efficiently manage their finances.

References

- Canva, 2026. What will you design today? [online] Available at: < https://www.canva.com/en_gb/ > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Sgwebapp, 2025. Must-Have Features of an Expense Tracker App: A Complete Guide for 2025. *Sgwebapp*, [blog] 09 June 2025. Available at: < <https://www.sgwebapp.com/blog/expense-tracker-app-development> > [Accessed 15 March 2026].
- Svitla., 2024. A Definitive Guide on How to Build a Personal Finance App. *Svitla.com*, [blog] 5 March. Available at: < <https://svitla.com/blog/personal-finance-app-development/> > [Accessed 13 March 2026].
- Digital Humanity, 2026. How to Build a Budgeting App in South Africa (Complete 2026 Guide). [online] Available at: < <https://digitalhumanity.co.za/insights/build-budgeting-app-south-africa/> > [Accessed 14 March 2026].
- Eleken, 2025. Learn How Budget App Design Works (From People Who've Just Designed One). *Eleken.co*, [blog] 1 December. Available at: < <https://www.eleken.co/blog-posts/budget-app-design> > [Accessed 14 March 2026].

- Grantham, R., 2025. 5 Essential Features to Look for in a Budgeting App. *TheBudgetBit.com*, [blog] 20 August. Available at:
< <https://thebudgetbit.com/5-essential-features-to-look-for-in-a-budgeting-app/> >
[Accessed 14 March 2026].